# Year 9 Admission Assessment

**Version 3.1, October 2026**

| | |
|---|---|
| **Name** | |
| **Date** | |

## Welcome

These activities help us get to know you.
Do your best.
It is fine if you cannot answer every question.
Your teacher will tell you when to start each part.

## How to answer

**Tick** one box.

Which one is a fruit? a chair ☐ an apple ☑ a bus ☐

**Write** your answer in the box.

12 + 8 = **20**

**Show** your working. You can get marks for your working, even if your answer is wrong.

Working
**4 × 25 = 100, 100 + 30 = 130**

## The parts of this paper

| Part | What you do | Time |
|---|---|---|
| **Listening** | A conversation and a short talk. Answer 16 questions. | 10 minutes |
| **Reading** | Read two texts. Answer the questions. | 15 minutes |
| **Writing** | Write a story or an article. | 10 minutes |
| Break | | 5 minutes |
| **Maths** | Fluency, word questions and applied problems. | 25 minutes |
| **Science** | Questions with pictures, tables and graphs. | 8 minutes |

You may use a pencil, a rubber and a ruler.
You may use a calculator **only** in Maths Section C.

# Listening

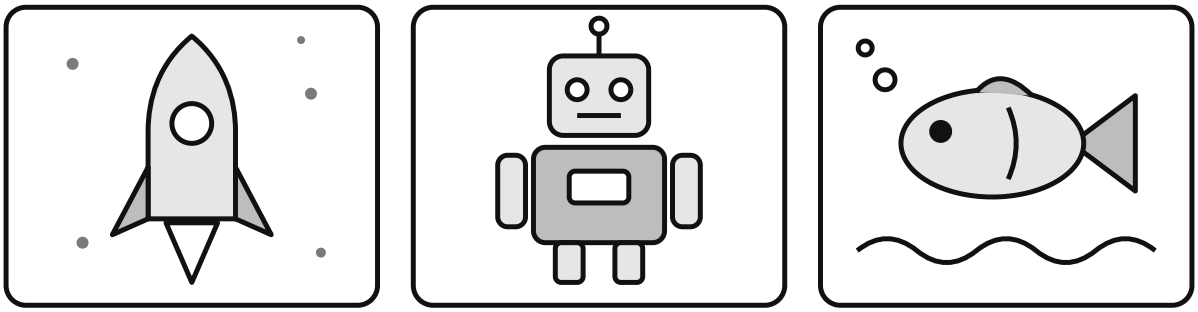
There are two parts: **A** and **B**.
Your teacher will read each part **two times**.
Before each part, you have one minute to read the questions.
**Listen** carefully. You can answer while you listen, or after.

## Part A

You will hear two friends talking.

**1** / 1

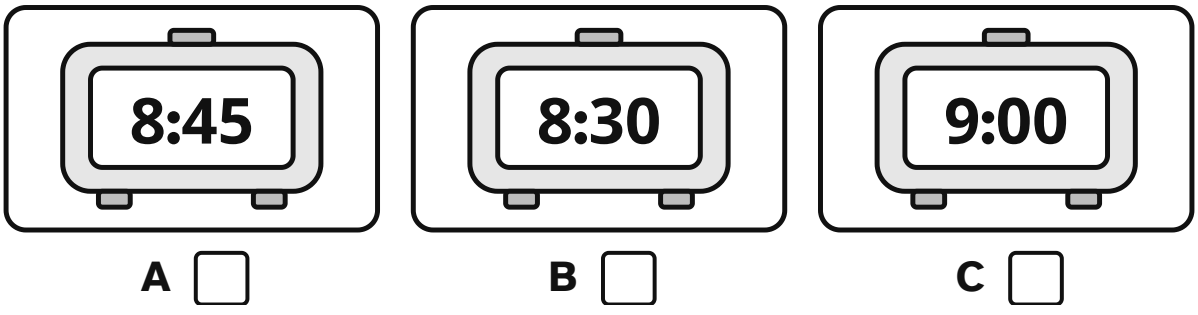
What is the new exhibition about?
**Tick** one picture.



A ☐ B ☐ C ☐

**2** / 1

What time do they meet at the school gate?
**Tick** one clock.

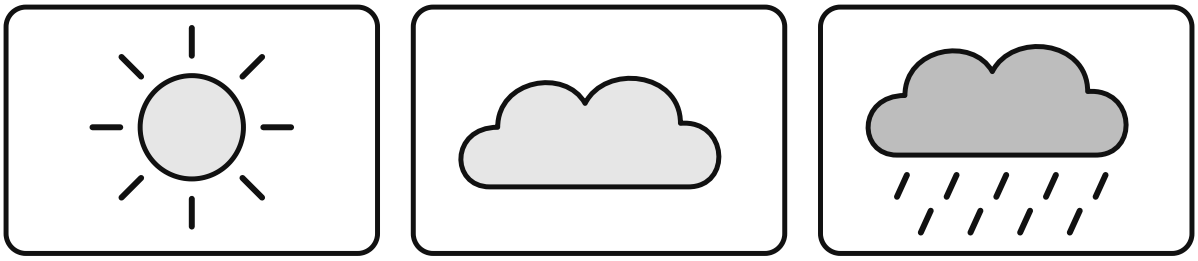



A ☐ B ☐ C ☐

**3** / 1

What will the weather be like in the afternoon?

**Tick** one picture.



A ☐ B ☐ C ☐

**4** / 1

How much does lunch in the museum café cost?

☐ yuan

**5** / 1

What must everyone bring to get a free ticket?

☐

**6** / 1

What time do they get back?

☐

**7** / 1

Mei says, "Most of the day is inside, anyway."

What does she mean?

**Tick** one.

- ☐ The rain will not be a big problem.
- ☐ They will not go to the museum.
- ☐ Tom must stay at home.

**8** / 1

Why does Mei tell Tom about Jun?

## Part B

You will hear a short talk about tea. A scientist, Dr Lin, is talking to a class.
You have one minute to read questions 9 to 16 first.
**Part B is harder. Do as much as you can.**

**9** / 1

What is the main purpose of Dr Lin's talk?
**Tick** one.

- ☐ To tell the story of the emperor Shennong.
- ☐ To explain where tea came from and why there are different kinds.
- ☐ To show that green tea is better than black tea.

**10** / 1

Dr Lin tells the story of the emperor Shennong.
What does she think about this story?
**Tick** one.

- ☐ It is the best evidence we have about where tea began.
- ☐ It is a nice story, but it may not be true.
- ☐ Historians have proved that it is wrong.

**11** / 1

Lu Yu wrote the first book about tea. When did he write it?

more than ☐ years ago

**12** / 1

When did Dutch traders bring the first tea to Europe?

in the early ☐

## 13 and 14

/ 2

**Complete** the notes.

**Write** one to three words in each gap.

**Example**

Green tea, black tea and oolong all come from the same **plant** .

**Notes: the science of tea**

**13** Pickers take only the top two leaves and the _____ .

**14** Oxidation: chemicals in a crushed leaf react with _____ in the air.

## 15

/ 1

How is black tea made?

**Write** 2, 3 and 4 in the boxes to show the order of the steps.

Step 1 is done for you.

**1** The leaves are withered: they are spread out until they go soft.

_____ The leaves are dried.

_____ The leaves are left in warm air.

_____ The leaves are rolled to break them.

## 16

/ 1

In English, people say "tea", not "cha".

**Use** the talk to **explain** why.

# Reading

There are two parts: **A** and **B**.
Part B is harder than Part A.
**Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish.**
You have 15 minutes. When you finish, wait for your teacher.

## Part A

**Read** the poster. Then **answer** questions 1 to 7.

### Greenhill Sports Centre

Summer activities for ages 12 to 16

| | Activity | Day | Time | Price |
|---|---|---|---|---|
|  | Basketball | Monday and Wednesday | 16:00 to 17:30 | ¥20 |
|  | Swimming | Tuesday and Thursday | 15:30 to 16:30 | ¥25 |
|  | Table tennis | Saturday | 9:00 to 11:00 | ¥15 |
|  | Climbing | Saturday | 14:00 to 16:00 | ¥40 |
|  | Yoga | Sunday | 10:00 to 11:00 | Free |

- Swimming: please bring a swimming cap.
- Climbing: ages 13 and over only.
- Book at the front desk or on our app.
- Open every day, 8:00 to 21:00.

**1** / 1

Which activity is on Tuesday and Thursday? _____

**2** / 1

How much does table tennis cost? _____

**3** / 1

Which activity is free? _____

**4** / 1

What must you bring to swimming? _____

**5** / 2

**Tick** True or False for each sentence.

| Sentence | True | False |
|---|---|---|
| The centre is open every day. | ☑ | ☐ |

| Sentence | True | False |
|---|---|---|
| Basketball is on Saturday. | ☐ | ☐ |
| Climbing finishes at 16:00. | ☐ | ☐ |
| You can book on the app. | ☐ | ☐ |
| Yoga is in the evening. | ☐ | ☐ |

**6** / 1

Wang Hao is 12 years old. Can he go climbing?

**Tick** one. Then **write** why.

☐ Yes ☐ No

Why? _____

**7** / 1

Li Na is free only on Saturday mornings.

Which activity can she do? _____

## Part B

**Read** the story. Then **answer** questions 8 to 14.

**Halfway Up**

From the ground, the climbing wall had looked easy. Now, eight metres up, Mei was not so sure.

Her right hand was on a small red hold, no bigger than a coin. Her left foot rested on a ledge so narrow that only her toes fitted on it. Below her, the sports hall had gone strangely quiet. She could hear her own breathing, fast and loud.

"You're doing great, Mei!" That was Coach Zhang, who was holding her rope. His voice sounded very far away.

Mei looked up. The next hold was a blue one, just out of reach. To get it, she would have to let go with one hand and push up hard with her legs. For one terrible second, she would be holding on with almost nothing.

She had done this move a hundred times at training, two metres above a soft mat. It was exactly the same move. That was what she told herself. Her body did not believe her.

Her arms began to shake. Sweat made her fingers slippery. She thought about the other girls in the competition, who had all reached the top. She thought about how easy it would be to shout "Lower me down!" and float gently back to the floor. Nobody would really blame her.

Then a small voice called out from somewhere near the door. "Go on, Mei!"

It was Bo, her little brother. He was six, and he was standing on a chair so that he could see. Mum was holding on to the back of his T-shirt. He was waving a sign made from a cereal box. In wobbly letters, it said: MEI CAN FLY.

Mei almost laughed. Something tight in her chest seemed to loosen. She breathed out slowly, bent her knees and pushed.

Her fingers closed around the blue hold.

Five moves later, she slapped the top of the wall, and the quiet hall exploded into noise.

**8** / 1

How high up the wall is Mei at the start of the story? _____

**9** / 1

"Her body did not believe her." What does this sentence mean?

**Tick** one.

- ☐ Mei's body was too tired to climb.
- ☐ Mei knew the move was easy, but she still felt afraid.
- ☐ Mei did not know how to do the move.

**10** / 2

**Write** two things from the text that show Mei was frightened.

1. 
2. 

**11** / 1

The writer tells us that the other girls "had all reached the top".

Why do you think the writer tells us this?

**12** / 1

Why did Mei almost laugh when she saw Bo's sign?

**13** / 1

"the quiet hall exploded into noise"

What does "exploded" mean in this sentence?

**14** / 1

How do Mei's feelings change from the start of the story to the end?

# Writing

**Choose one** task: A or B.

**Tick** the box for the task you choose.

**Plan** your ideas in the plan box. Then **write** on the lines.

You have 10 minutes. Write as much as you can.

### Task A: a story ☐

**Write** a story that begins with this sentence:

> When I opened my bag, I found something that was not mine.

Ideas: What did you find? Whose was it? What did you do? How did the story end?

### Task B: an article ☐

Your school magazine asks this question:

> Should every school day include one hour of sport?

**Write** an article for the magazine. Give your opinion and at least two reasons.

Ideas: health, friends, time for study, examples from your own life.

---

### Plan

Notes and ideas (this part is not marked)

## Your writing

Task A ☐ Task B ☐

# Maths

You have 25 minutes. Do as much as you can.

There are three sections: **A**, **B** and **C**.

**Write** your answer in the box. **Show** your working in the working box.

Your teacher can read any question to you.

**Sections A and B:** you may **not** use a calculator.

**Section C:** you **may** use a calculator.

## Section A: Fluency (no calculator)

**What the maths words mean**

**Simplify:** $3a + 5a = 8a$

**Expand:** $3(x + 2) = 3x + 6$

**Factorise:** $x^2 + 5x = x(x + 5)$

**Standard form:** $4500 = 4.5 \times 10^3$

**Make $x$ the subject:** $y = x + 4$, so $x = y - 4$

**1** / 2

(a) **Write** $2^{-3}$ as a fraction.

(b) **Simplify** $(2x^3)^2$

**2** / 2

**Work out** $(3 \times 10^4) \times (5 \times 10^{-7})$

**Give** your answer in standard form.

Working

**3** / 2

**Expand and simplify** $(2x - 3)(x + 4)$

Working

**4** / 1

**Factorise** $x^2 - 2x - 15$

**5** / 2

**Solve** the simultaneous equations.

$2x + 3y = 7$

$5x - 2y = 8$

Working

$x =$ $y =$

**6** / 1

**Make** $x$ the subject of the formula $y = \dfrac{3x - 2}{5}$

Working

$x =$

## Section B: Word questions (no calculator)

These questions are in words only. **Read** each one carefully.
You can **write** an equation, then **solve** it.

**Example: write an equation, then solve it**

Mei is 3 years older than Jun. Their ages add up to 29. How old is Jun?

Let Jun's age be $j$. Then Mei's age is $j + 3$.

**Equation:** $j + (j + 3) = 29$

**Solve:** $2j + 3 = 29$, so $2j = 26$, so $j = 13$

**Answer:** Jun is 13 years old.

**7** / 2

A printer prints 84 pages in 6 minutes.
It always prints at the same speed.
How long does it take to print 210 pages?

Working

minutes

**8** / 2

In a sale, every price is reduced by 20%.
Amir pays ¥96 for a pair of trainers in the sale.
What was the price of the trainers before the sale?

Working

¥

**9** / 2

3 pens and 2 notebooks cost ¥26 altogether.
1 pen and 4 notebooks cost ¥32 altogether.
All the pens are the same price. All the notebooks are the same price.
**Work out** the cost of one pen and the cost of one notebook.

Working

One pen: ¥ One notebook: ¥

**10** / 2

A rectangle is 3 cm longer than it is wide.

Its area is 40 cm².

The width of the rectangle is $w$ cm.

**Write** an equation in $w$. Then **solve** it to find the width.

Working

Equation: ☐

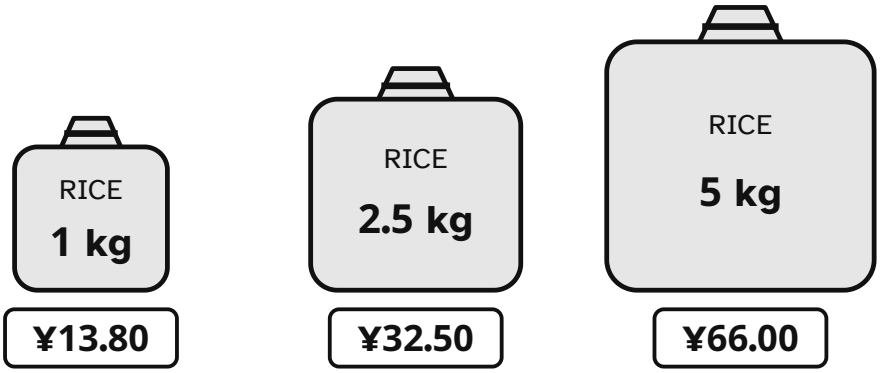
Width = ☐ cm

## Section C: Applied problems (you may use a calculator)

Each problem has more than one step. **Show** your working.

**11** / 2

A shop sells rice in three sizes.




Which bag is the best value for money? **Show** how you decide.

Working

**Tick** one. ☐ 1 kg ☐ 2.5 kg ☐ 5 kg

## 12

/ 2

Li Na has ¥5000. She wants to save it for 4 years.
She can choose one of two bank accounts.

| | **Account A** | **Account B** |
|---|---|---|
| Interest | 3% **simple** interest per year | 2.6% **compound** interest per year |
| How it works | Each year, the bank adds 3% of the ¥5000 that she put in. | Each year, the bank adds 2.6% of the money in the account at that time. |

Which account gives Li Na more money after 4 years? **Show** your working.

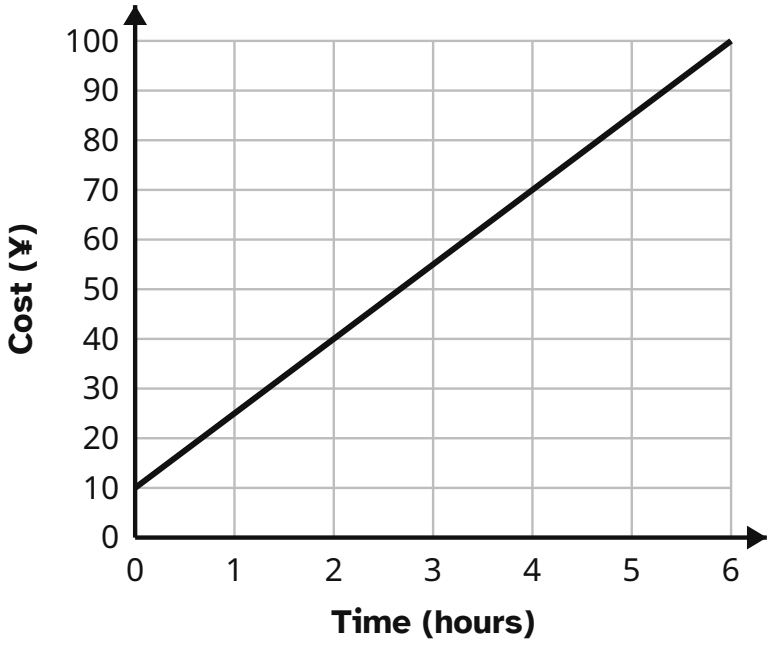
Working

**Tick** one. ☐ Account A ☐ Account B

## 13

/ 2

A bike hire company charges a fixed fee, plus an amount for each hour.
The graph shows the cost of hiring one bike.




(a) **Work out** the gradient of the line.

(b) **Explain** what the gradient tells you about the cost of hiring a bike.

## 14

/ 3

A water tank is a cylinder.

The diameter is 80 cm and the height is 120 cm.

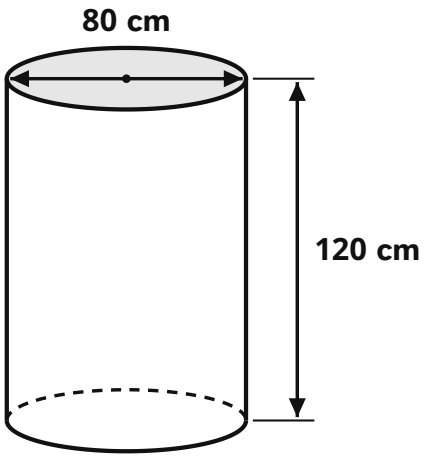
The tank is empty. Water flows in at 15 litres per minute.

How long does it take to fill the tank?

**Give** your answer to the nearest minute.

1 litre = 1000 $cm^3$

*Not drawn accurately*



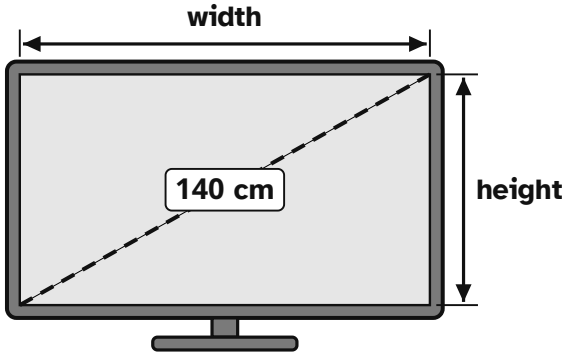

Working

[ ] minutes

## 15

/ 3

TV screens are measured along the diagonal.
This TV screen has a diagonal of 140 cm.
The width and the height of the screen are in the ratio 16 : 9.




*Not drawn accurately*

**Show that** the width of the screen is about 122 cm.

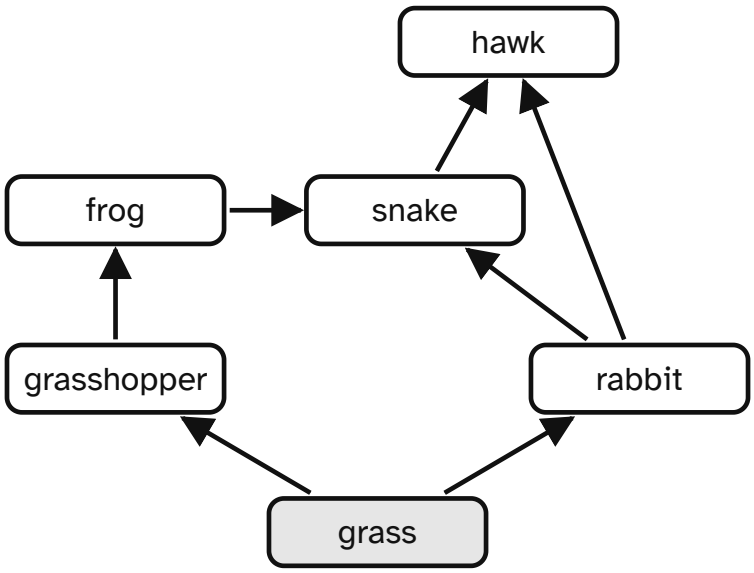
Working

# Science

You have 8 minutes. Do as much as you can.
Your teacher can read any question to you.

**1** / 2

This is a food web. An arrow means "is eaten by".




(a) **Write** the name of the producer. ☐

(b) The number of frogs goes down. What happens to the number of grasshoppers?

☐ It goes up. ☐ It goes down. ☐ It stays the same.

**Explain** why.

**2** / 1

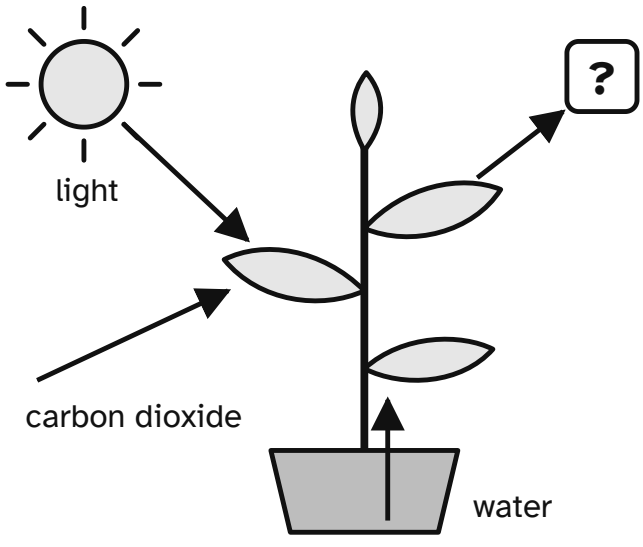
Plants make glucose by photosynthesis.

A gas comes out of the leaf (**?** in the picture).

**Complete** the word equation.

carbon dioxide + water

→ glucose + ☐

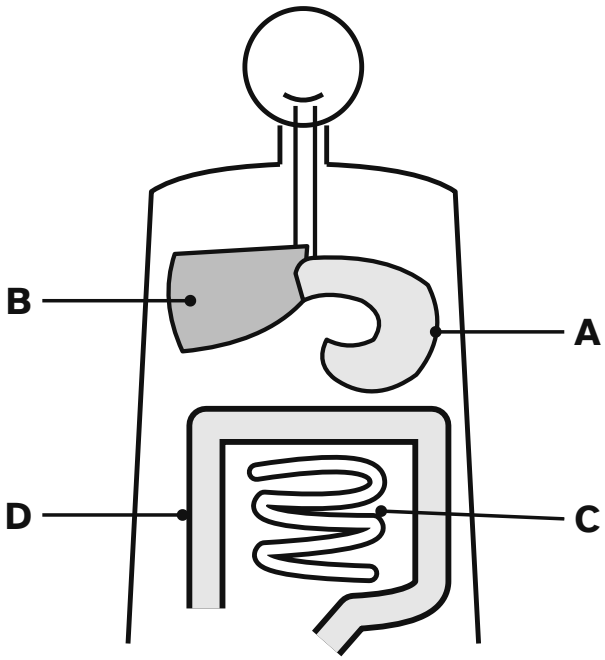


**3** / 1

This is the human digestive system.

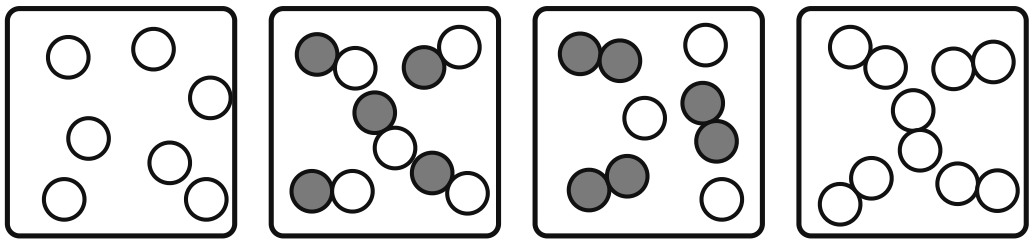
Where is most digested food absorbed into the blood?

**Write** the letter.




**4** / 2

Each circle is an atom. Atoms of different elements have different shading.

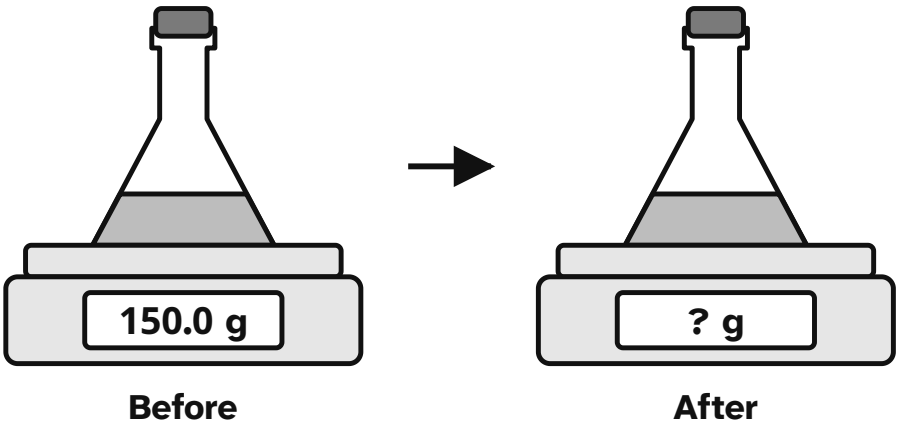



(a) Which box shows a **compound**? **Write** the letter.

(b) Which box shows a **mixture**? **Write** the letter.

**5** / 1

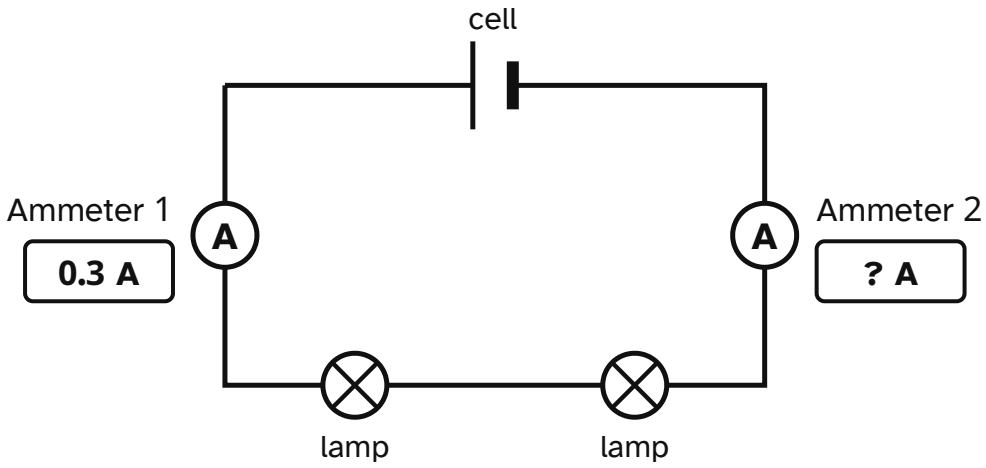
Wang Hao puts two chemicals in a flask. He closes the flask, so nothing can get in or out. The chemicals react.




What does the balance read **after** the reaction? _____ g

**6** / 1

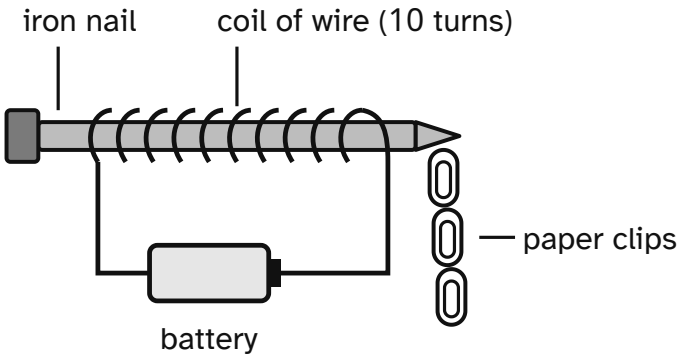
This is a series circuit. Ammeter 1 reads 0.3 A.




What does ammeter 2 read? _____ A

**7** / 2

Wang Hao makes an electromagnet. He changes the number of turns of wire on the nail. He counts how many paper clips the nail picks up.




| **Number of turns of wire** | **10** | **20** | **30** | **40** |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Number of paper clips | 3 | 6 | 9 | ? |

(a) **Write** one thing he must keep the same to make it a fair test.

(b) **Predict** the number of paper clips for 40 turns. ☐

**Thank you. You have finished. Please wait for your teacher.**

# Year 9 grading sheet (version 3.1)

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Candidate name** | | **Candidate number** | |
| **Date of birth** | | **Current school** | |
| **Date of assessment** | | **Assessor** | |

**Paper version sat: v3.1** (on the front page of the student paper). **For staff only.** Mark the student paper first (every question has a mark box; answers and mark schemes are in `Y09_Assessor_Instructions_v3.1`). Copy the totals here and give the bands from the guide below. Reading is recorded on the **Reading front sheet** and speaking on the **Interview sheet**.

| Part | Score | Band | Notes (NT, L, access arrangements, behaviour) |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Listening** (Part A / 8, Part B / 8) | A ___ + B ___ = ___ / 16 | ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E | |
| **Writing** (four criteria, each / 4) | content ___ vocabulary ___ grammar ___ spelling and punctuation ___ = ___ / 16 | ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E | Task chosen: A B |
| **Maths** (Fluency / 10, Word questions / 8, Applied / 12) | F ___ + W ___ + A ___ = ___ / 30 | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | NT:<br>L: |
| **Science** (/ 10) | ___ / 10 | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | NT:<br>L: |
| **Reading** | Reading front sheet | | |
| **Speaking** | Interview sheet | | |

**Maths profile.** Fluency ___ % · Word questions ___ % · Applied ___ %.

☐ Fluency much higher than word questions: was the barrier English? (A word question solved after it was read aloud or given in Chinese.)

☐ Fluency and word questions much higher than applied: needs teaching in problem solving and explaining.

**Not yet taught (NT) topics, and the likely maths and science band once taught:**

**Access arrangements** (extra time, reader, breaks) and **behaviour and wellbeing** during the assessment:

**Assessor's comment** (strengths, English barrier or not, what support the student would need, anything to follow up):

**Assessor signature and date** _____

**Band guide at a glance (full guide and judgement notes: `Y09_Assessor_Instructions_v3.1`)**

| Band | Listening (/ 16) | Writing (/ 16; best fit decides) | Maths (/ 30) | Science (/ 10) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **A** or **1** | Part A 0 to 2 | 0 to 3 | 1 Below expected: 0 to 10 | 1: 0 to 3 |
| **B** or **2** | Part A 3 to 4 | 4 to 7 | 2 Working towards: 11 to 16 | 2: 4 to 5 |
| **C** or **3** | Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2 | 8 to 10 | 3 Expected: 17 to 22 | 3: 6 to 8 |
| **D** or **4** | Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5 | 11 to 13 | 4 Greater depth: 23 to 30 | 4: 9 to 10 |
| **E** | Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8 | 14 to 16 | | |

# Reading front sheet: reading levels and sentence reading

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Candidate name** | | **Candidate number** | |
| **Year group applied for** | | **Date of birth** | |
| **Age today (years:months)** | | **Date** | |

**For staff only. One sheet for each candidate, all year groups.** The assessor fills in Part 1 and gives this sheet to the interviewer (usually the principal) before the interview. The interviewer, or in Years 1 to 3 the assessor, runs the sentence reading with `Sentence_Reading_Guide` and records it in Part 2. Part 3 gives the reading result for the final mark sheet.

### 1. Reading levels so far (the assessor fills this in)

| Item | Details |
|---|---|
| Handed over by, and time | Handed over by _____ at _____ Received by _____ |
| Years 1 to 3: Early Reading Screen (its Sheet 13) | Letter sounds ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 Phonics words ___ / 40 Tricky words ___ / 20 Book band _____ (Oxford Level ___) Accuracy ___ % Questions ___ / ___ |
| Years 4 to 6: reading paper | Part A ___ / 8 Part B ___ / 8 Part C ___ / 8 Total ___ / 24 |
| Years 7 to 10: reading paper | Part A ___ / 8 Part B ___ / 8 Total ___ / 16 Stopped at 15 minutes at question ___ |
| Reading band so far | ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E |
| Sentence reading starts at | ☐ the level for the year group (table below) ☐ Level 1, because the student is new to English |
| Tell the interviewer | (for example: shy, needs more time, stopped early, anxious about English) |

| Year group | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Start at level (first sentence) | 1 (1) | 1 (1) | 2 (4) | 3 (7) | 4 (10) | 5 (13) | 6 (16) | 7 (19) | 8 (22) | 9 (25) |

### 2. Sentence reading (Graded Sentence Reading Screen)

Run by: ☐ interviewer ☐ assessor (Years 1 to 3, after the Early Reading Screen). Write 2, 1 or 0 for each sentence (none, one, two or more errors), then the meaning check and the level total. **Levels below the start level:** write 6 in the total if the student scored 6 out of 6 on the start level (guide, Section 1). **Stop** at the end of a level with 2 points or fewer, after three 0s in a row, or if the student is upset.

| Level | Sentence a | Sentence b | Sentence c | Meaning check | Level total |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 (sentences 1 to 3) | | | | ☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗ | / 6 |
| 2 (4 to 6) | | | | ☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗ | / 6 |
| 3 (7 to 9) | | | | ☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗ | / 6 |
| 4 (10 to 12) | | | | ☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗ | / 6 |
| 5 (13 to 15) | | | | ☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗ | / 6 |
| 6 (16 to 18) | | | | ☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗ | / 6 |
| 7 (19 to 21) | | | | ☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗ | / 6 |
| 8 (22 to 24) | | | | ☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗ | / 6 |
| 9 (25 to 27) | | | | ☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗ | / 6 |
| 10 (28 to 30) | | | | ☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗ | / 6 |
| 11 (31 to 33) | | | | ☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗ | / 6 |
| 12 (34 to 36) | | | | ☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗ | / 6 |

Errors, what the student said when you are not sure, and **patterns noticed** (S substitution, O omission, I insertion, T told; SC self-correction is not an error). Patterns such as missing -ed or -s endings, or pinyin letter values, are useful evidence:

---

---

### 3. Result (copy to the final mark sheet)

| Measure | Result |
|---|---|
| Total points (including 6 for each level below the start level that was not read) | ___ / 72 |
| Reading age (5:00 plus 2 months for every point: 6 points = 6:00, 12 = 7:00, 30 = 10:00, 60 = 15:00, 72 = 17:00) | _____ : _____ |
| Actual age (years:months) and difference (reading age minus actual age) | Actual _____ : _____ Difference _____ months |
| Meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓) | ___ asked, ___ ✓ |
| Fluency on the last level read with 4 or more points (1 word by word, 2 two or three words, 3 sensible phrases, 4 smooth) | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 |
| Indicative reading band from the sentence reading (table below) | ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E |
| Reading band for the final mark sheet (the Early Reading Screen in Years 1 to 3, the reading paper in Years 4 to 10; if it differs from the sentence reading by more than one band, say why) | ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E |

**Band from the reading age (the full guide and the notes are in `Sentence_Reading_Guide`)**

| Reading age compared with actual age | Years 3 to 5 | Years 6 to 10 | Band |
|---|---|---|---|
| At or above actual age, or close below it | up to 6 months below | up to 12 months below | **E** |
| Below | 7 to 12 months below | 13 to 24 months below | **D** |
| Well below | 13 to 24 months below | 25 to 42 months below | **C** |
| Far below | 25 to 36 months below | 43 to 60 months below | **B** |
| Very far below, or Level 1 not secure | more than 36 months below | more than 60 months below | **A** |

Years 1 and 2: use the reading age as supporting evidence only. If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one (decoding ahead of understanding).

# Interview sheet: Years 7 to 10

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Candidate name** | | **Candidate number** | |
| **Year group applied for** | | **Date** | |
| **Interviewer** | | **Others present** | |

Questions and descriptors: `forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`. Sentence reading is recorded on the Reading front sheet. For staff only.

### Speaking and listening

Speaking band: ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E

Listening in conversation (how much of your English they understood): ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E

Notes on pronunciation and intelligibility (pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand):

### Key things the student said (their own words, and how they said it)

### Suitability

**1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

| Strand | Rating | Evidence (a short quotation or what you saw) |
|---|---|---|
| Attitude to learning and resilience | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |
| Curiosity and engagement | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |
| Social and emotional readiness | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |
| Independence and self-management | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |
| Values and conduct | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |
| Readiness for English-medium learning | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |
| Clarity and ownership of future plans | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |
| Boarding readiness (only if the student will board) | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |

## Anything to follow up

| Area | Tick | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision) | ☐ | |
| Wellbeing (for example anxiety, low mood, very heavy workload, sleep) | ☐ | |
| Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day) | ☐ | |
| Medical or dietary | ☐ | |
| Mismatch between the student's wishes and the family's plans | ☐ | |

## Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

First impressions, and what the student would need in the first weeks:

## Interviewer's comment for the final mark sheet

Strengths, concerns, support:

**Interviewer signature and date** _____

# Parent conversation record

| | |
|---|---|
| **Candidate name** | |
| **Year group applied for** | |
| **Date** | |
| **Staff member** | |
| **Parents or carers present** | |
| **Language used (and interpreter if any)** | |

**About 15 minutes.** Hold it while the student does the written tasks with another adult, or straight after. Use the family's preferred language; a Chinese-speaking colleague should lead or interpret if the staff member does not speak Chinese. The aim is a two-way conversation: to understand the child and the family's hopes, to explain how the international programme works, and to check that what the family wants matches what the school offers. Do not discuss the assessment results on the day.

## 1. Why the international programme?

| Question | Notes |
|---|---|
| Why are you looking for a place in the international programme, and why now? | |
| What do you know about how the programme works (lessons in English, the UK-style curriculum, assessment, homework, activities)? | |
| Whose idea is the move, and how does your child feel about it? | |

## 2. Schooling so far

| Question | Notes |
|---|---|
| Schools attended, years, and type (Chinese mainstream, bilingual, international, overseas) | |
| Any year repeated or skipped? Any long gaps? | |
| Why is the child leaving their current school? | |
| Student registration (学籍): where is it held now, and what will happen to it? (admissions office to give the school's position) | |
| School reports, certificates and any assessments the family can share | |

## 3. Languages

| Question | Notes |
|---|---|
| Which languages are spoken at home, and by whom? | |
| How has the child learnt English so far (school lessons from which grade, classes outside school, tutor, online, time abroad, English-speaking carer)? About how many hours a week? | |
| Does the child read in English at home? In Chinese? | |
| How will the family support English at home (reading, media, activities), and support Chinese if that matters to the family? | |

## 4. Learning, health and development

Ask gently and explain why: the school wants to have the right support ready from the first day.

| Question | Notes |
|---|---|
| What is your child good at? What do they enjoy most? | |
| Has any teacher or doctor ever raised a concern about learning, speech and language, attention, behaviour, hearing or vision? Any assessments or reports? | |
| Any extra help at the current school? | |
| Medical conditions, allergies, medication (also on the school medical form) | |
| For young children: speech in Chinese for their age, toilet and self-care, sleep | |

## 5. Wellbeing and the week

| Question | Notes |
|---|---|
| How would you describe your child's personality? How do they cope with change? | |
| Friendships: does your child make friends easily? | |
| A typical weekday and weekend: after-school classes, tutoring, sport, music, screen time, sleep | |
| Any big changes in the family recently (a move, a new baby, a parent working away)? Share only what you are comfortable sharing. | |

## 6. Expectations and partnership

| Question | Notes |
|---|---|
| What would make this a successful first year for your child? | |
| What do you expect from the school (homework, reports, communication, class rankings, exam results)? Explain how the school reports progress and how it communicates. | |
| How does the family feel about co-curricular activities, sport, arts, service and wellbeing as part of education, not just exam subjects? | |
| Learning in a new language takes time: explain what is typical (social English often within one to two years; the English needed for academic work often takes several years) and how the school supports it. How does the family feel about this? | |
| How would the family like to be involved (events, meetings, volunteering)? | |

## 7. Future plans

| Question | Notes |
|---|---|
| What are your hopes for your child in the long term (university, country, career)? | |
| Do you plan to stay in the international programme through to the end of school? | |
| Explain the programme's pathway (for example IGCSE, then the sixth form programme) and how it differs from the 中考 and 高考 route, using the admissions office's wording. Does the family understand that moving back to the national exam route later may not be straightforward? | |
| Year 10 applicants: which IGCSE subjects does the student hope to take? Explain that IGCSE is a two-year course starting in Year 10. | |

## 8. Boarding (only if the child will board)

| Question | Notes |
|---|---|
| Has the child stayed away from home before (camps, boarding, family)? How did it go? | |
| How independent are they with daily routines, sleep and belongings? | |
| How will the family keep in touch, and how often will the child go home? | |

## 9. Questions from the family

## 10. Staff view

| | Rating | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Match between the family's expectations and what the programme offers | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |
| Family's willingness to work in partnership with the school | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | |
| Information to follow up (reports, medical, assessments, 学籍) | | |

**1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

**Consent.** The parent or carer agrees that the school may contact the current school (homeroom teacher) for a reference: **Yes** ☐ **No** ☐

**Parent or carer signature** _____

**Staff signature and date** _____

# Final mark sheet: candidate summary and decision

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Candidate name** | | **Candidate number** | |
| **Year group applied for** | | **Date of birth** | |
| **Current school** | | **Date of assessment** | |

**Paper version sat:** _____ (v3.1; on the front page of the student paper). Complete within two working days from the **grading sheet**, **Reading front sheet**, **Interview sheet**, parent conversation record and homeroom teacher reference. This is the one overview that the head of section reads and that goes into the admissions system. The bands guide a professional decision; they are not a pass mark (guide, Sections 6 to 9).

## 1. English profile

| Skill | Evidence (copy the scores) | Band |
|---|---|---|
| Listening | Grading sheet: ___ / ___ ; listening in conversation (Interview sheet) | ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E |
| Speaking | Interview sheet (and picture talk on the grading sheet, Years 1 to 3) | ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E |
| Reading | Reading front sheet. Years 1 to 3: book band _____ accuracy ___% questions ___ ; phonics ___ / 40 ; letters ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 ; tricky words ___ / 20. Years 4 to 6: paper ___ / 24. Years 7 to 10: paper ___ / 16 | ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E |
| Reading aloud | Sentence reading (Reading front sheet): points ___ / 72 ; reading age _____ ; actual age _____ ; meaning checks ___ ; fluency ___ | indicative ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E |
| Writing | Grading sheet: ___ / 16 | ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E |
| **Overall English** | The band most of the four skills sit in. If one skill is two or more bands below the others, say which. | ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E |

**A** New to English, **B** Early acquisition, **C** Developing competence, **D** Competent, **E** Fluent (comparable to a fluent English speaker of the same age).

## 2. Maths and science

| | Score | Band | Number problems (Years 7 to 10: fluency) / word problems (word questions) / applied (Years 7 to 10) | Not yet taught (NT) and language support (L) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Maths | ___ / ___ | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | ___ / ___ ___ / ___ ___ / 12 | |
| Science (Years 5 to 10) | ___ / ___ | ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 | | |

**1** Well below expected (Years 7 to 10: below expected), **2** Working towards, **3** Expected, **4** Greater depth. The Years 7 to 10 papers are harder, so their boundaries are lower. Strong number problems with weak word problems may be an English barrier, not a maths difficulty. Years 7 to 10: strong fluency and word questions with weak applied problems means teaching in problem solving, not more content. NT questions score 0: say whether the student is likely to reach the expected band once taught.

**Year 10 only: readiness for IGCSE** (grading sheet; Year 10 instructions, Section 6). English course: ☐ First Language ☐ English as a Second Language ☐ to decide. Maths tier: ☐ Extended ☐ Core ☐ to decide. Overall: ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Not yet.

## 3. Suitability

| Source | Summary | Concerns (any strand rated 1) |
|---|---|---|
| Interview sheet (strands rated 1 to 4) | | |
| Parent conversation (match of expectations, partnership) | | |
| Previous homeroom teacher reference | | |
| School reports and documents | | |
| Follow-ups (special educational needs, wellbeing, medical, safeguarding referral made) | | |

## 4. Recommendation

Use the decision guide in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9. Tick one.

| | Recommendation |
|---|---|
| ☐ | **Offer.** Ready to join the year group with normal class support. |
| ☐ | **Offer with English support.** Ready academically; needs a planned English programme (state the level below). |
| ☐ | **Offer with a learning plan.** Needs catch-up in named maths or science topics, or other planned support; review date set. |
| ☐ | **Further assessment before a decision.** For example a second visit, a trial day, a specialist assessment, or more information from the family or school. |
| ☐ | **Unable to offer at this time.** The programme cannot meet the student's needs now. Give the reason and, where possible, what would change the decision. |

Year group confirmed: _____ (by age: yes / no; if no, give the reason and who approved it)

## 5. Support from the first day (if offered)

| Area | Plan |
|---|---|
| English support level | ☐ Intensive (new to English) ☐ Timetabled support lessons ☐ In-class support and monitoring ☐ None needed |
| Maths and science catch-up | |
| Reading (book band or reading age to start from) | |
| Pastoral (buddy, homeroom check-ins, boarding support) | |
| Information for the homeroom teacher | |
| Review date (for example after six weeks) | |

## 6. Comments and feedback

**Assessor** (from the grading sheet): strengths, gaps, NT topics, English barrier or not.

**Interviewer** (from the Interview sheet): what the student is like, hopes and plans, anything of concern.

**Feedback for the family.** Start with the child's strengths; use plain words; say what support we will give and, if no offer is made, what would change the decision.

## 7. Sign-off and records

| Role | Name | Signature | Date |
|---|---|---|---|
| Assessor | | | |
| Interviewer | | | |
| Head of section | | | |
| Admissions: outcome told to the family (start with the child's strengths) | | | |

Papers filed together: ☐ grading sheet ☐ Reading front sheet ☐ Interview sheet ☐ parent conversation record ☐ marked student paper. Entered in the admissions system: date _____ initials _____